

Snake

The king cobra is the world's longest venomous snake. It can grow more than 16 ft (5 m) in length and preys mainly on other snakes. However, the king cobra has a caring side too. Many snakes abandon their eggs immediately after laying them, but the king cobra builds a nest for its eggs and guards them until they hatch.

Wrestling

In the breeding season, males fight over females. They raise their heads high and then wrestle, trying to pin their rivals to the ground. The defeated snakes slink away.

Guarding the nest

The mother lies coiled on the nest, guarding her eggs. If she feels threatened, she opens her hood and gives a low hiss. She also raises part of her body off the ground. When really big king cobras rear up, they can be as tall as an adult human!

The venom of the babies is as deadly as the venom of the adults.

Babies hatching

Just before hatching time, the mother leaves the nest, leaving her babies to fend for themselves. In four to six years' time, the snakes will be old enough to breed.

The king cobra raises its hood to make itself look larger than it really is and scare off predators.